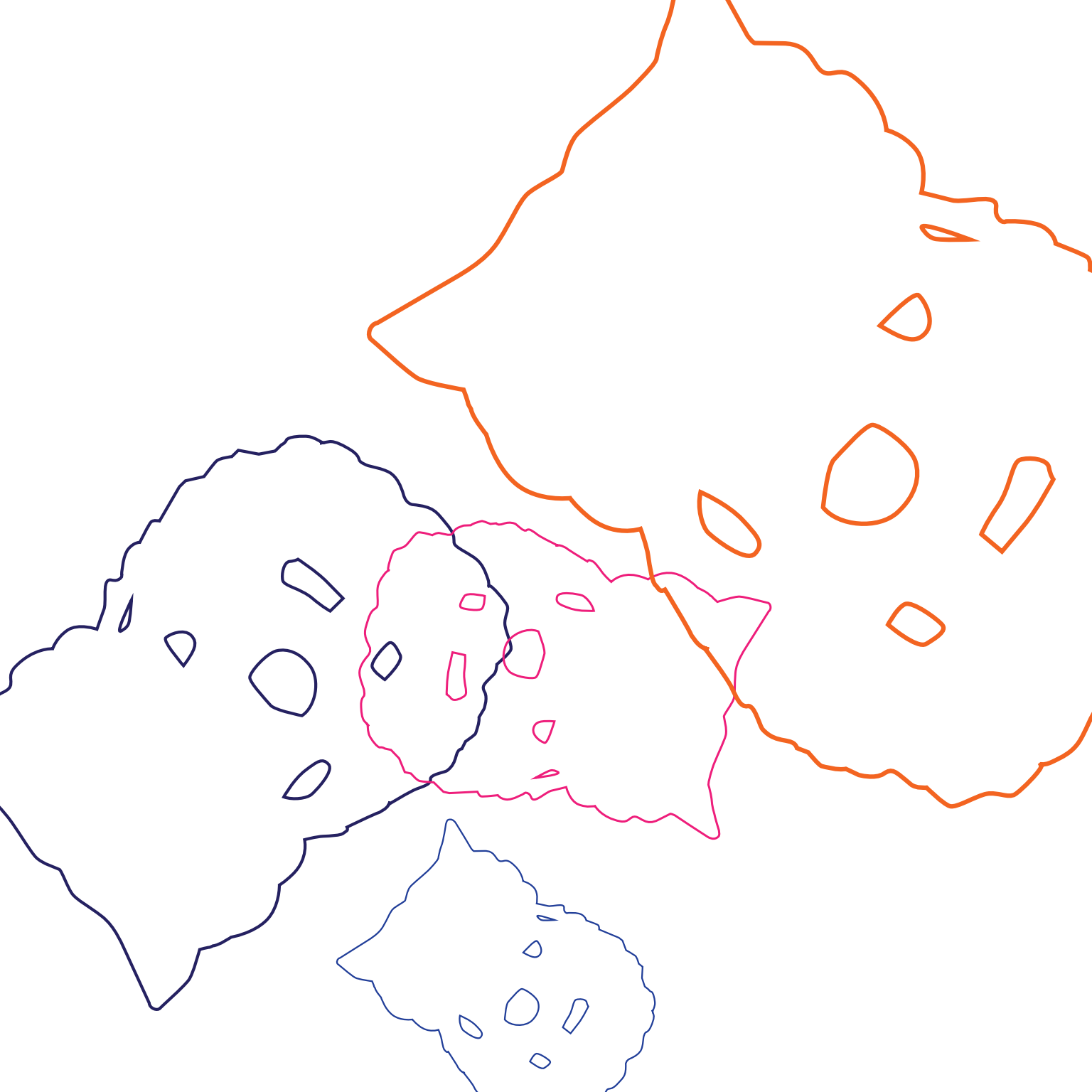
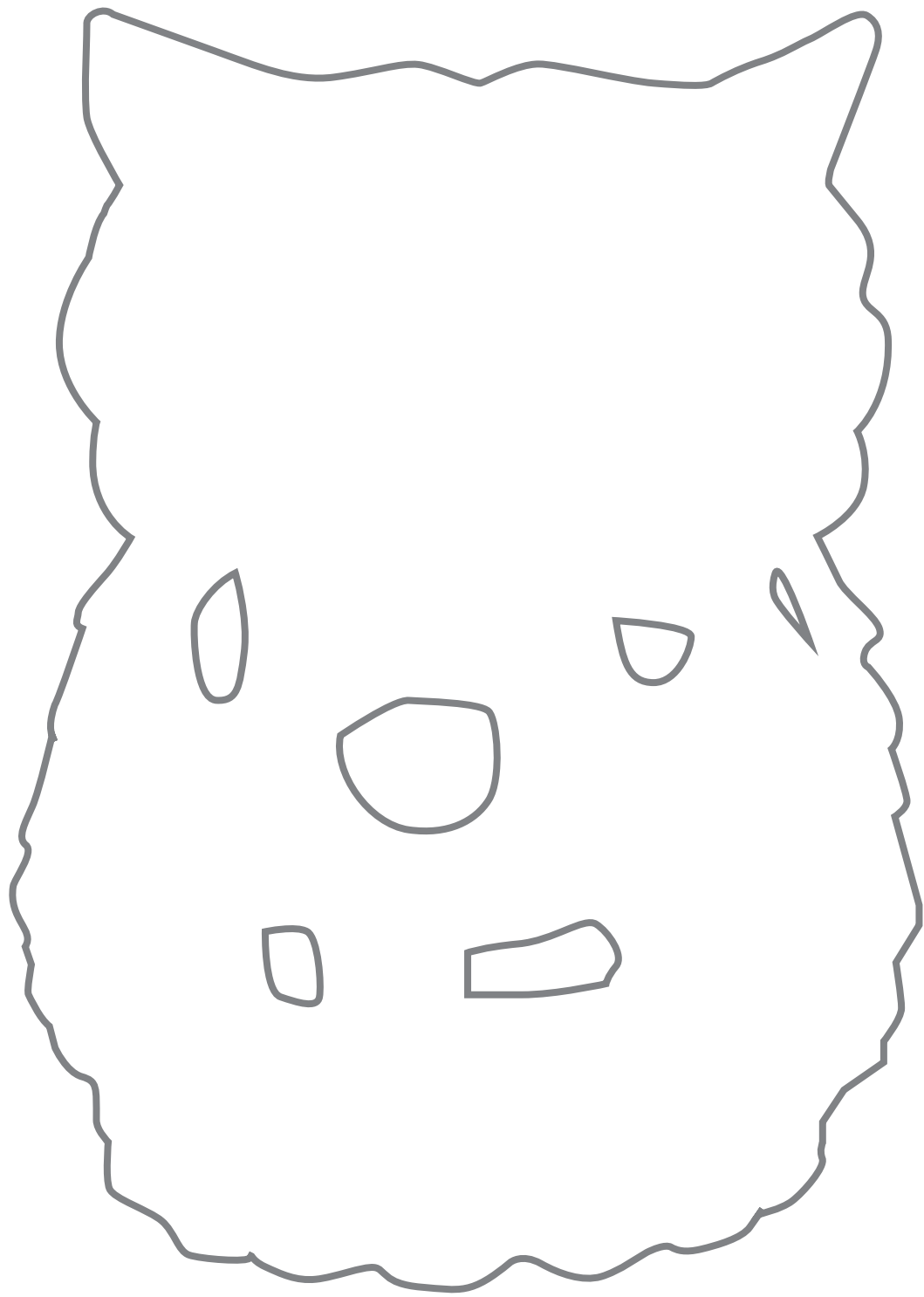






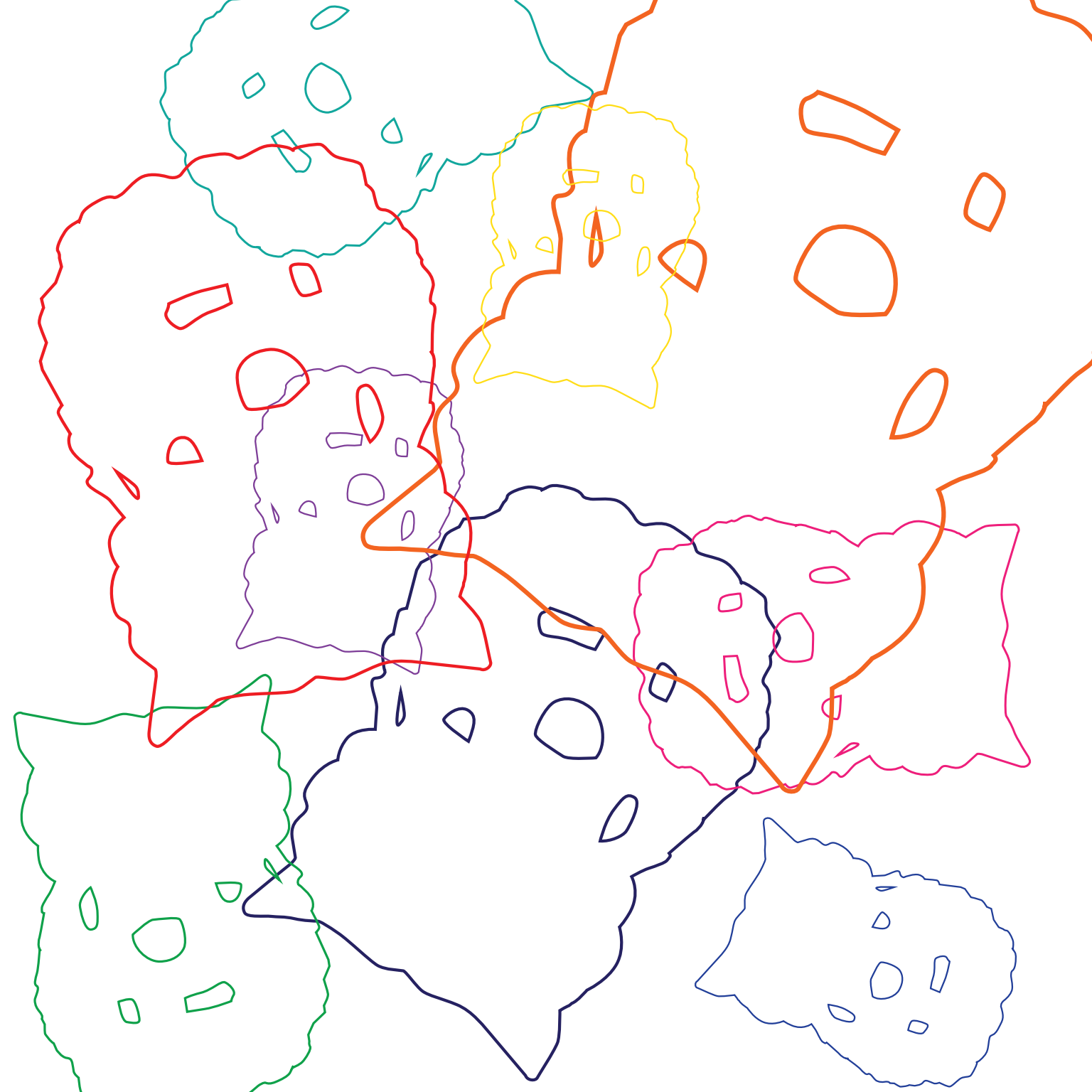
A ceramic owl with a candle glowing inside of him while he was flying in a dark.









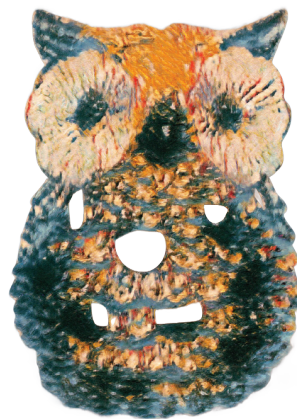
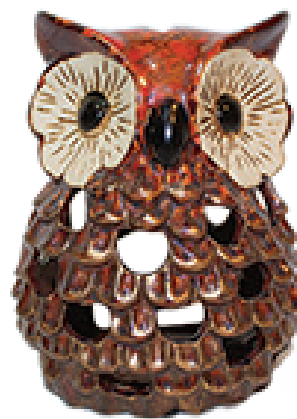










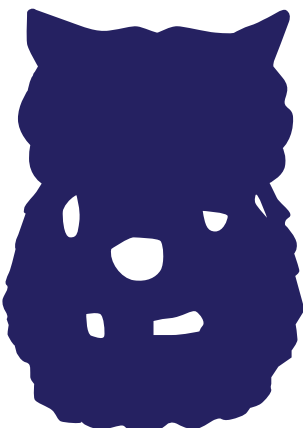
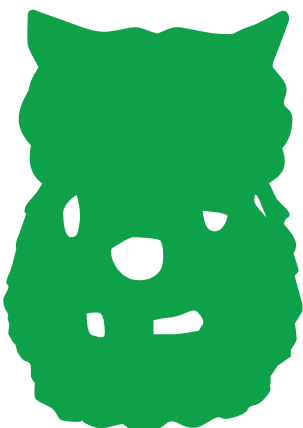


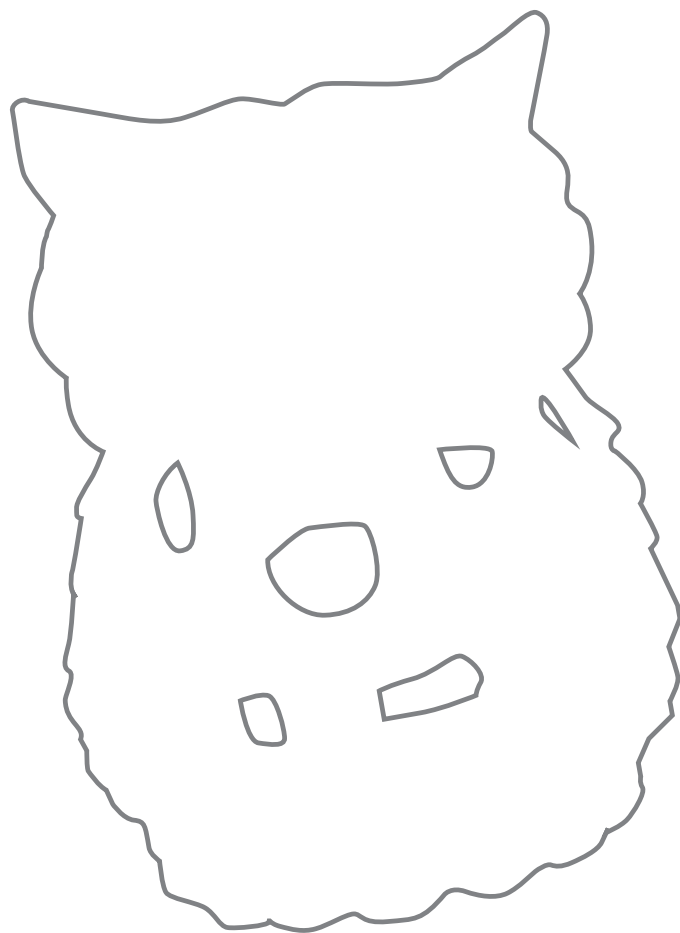






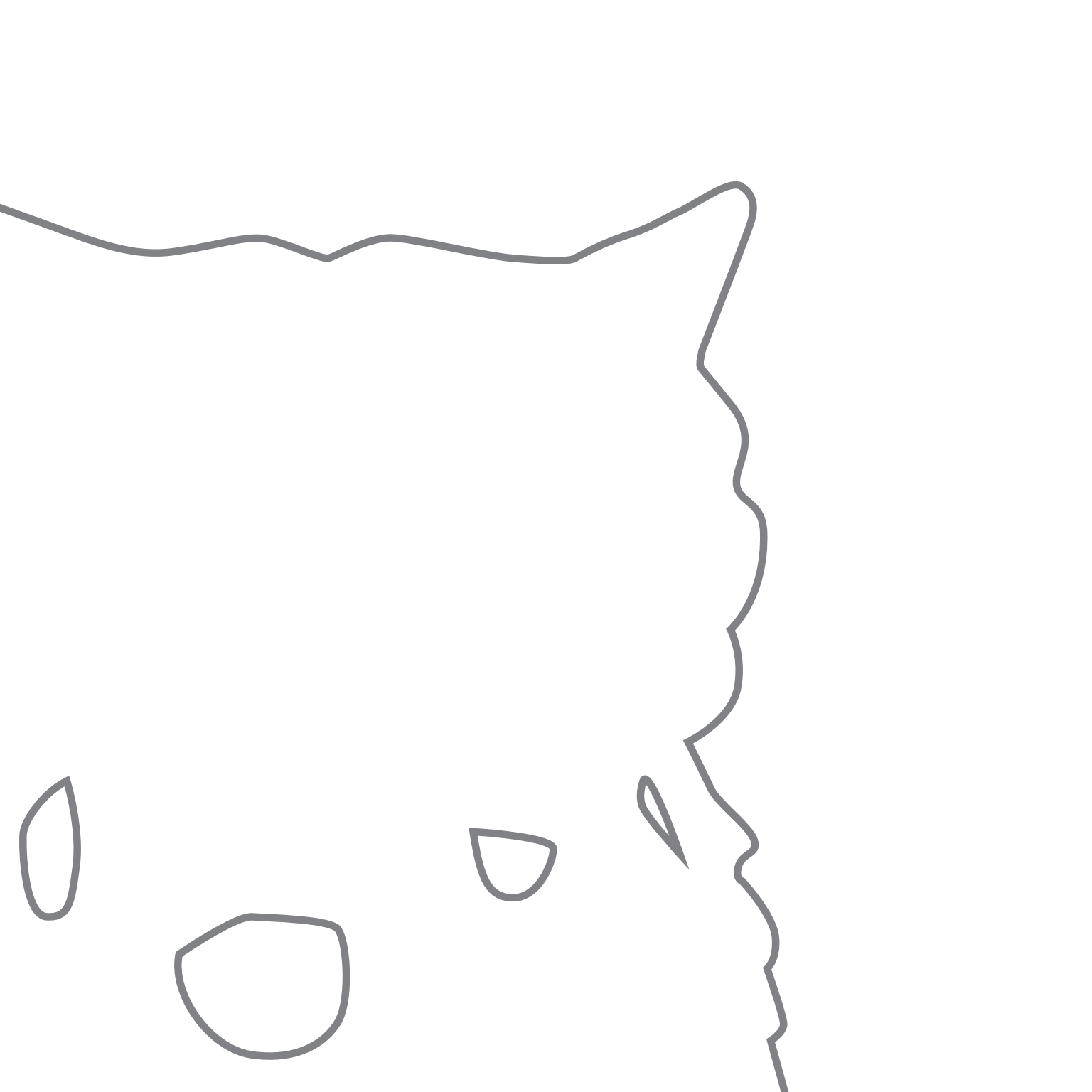




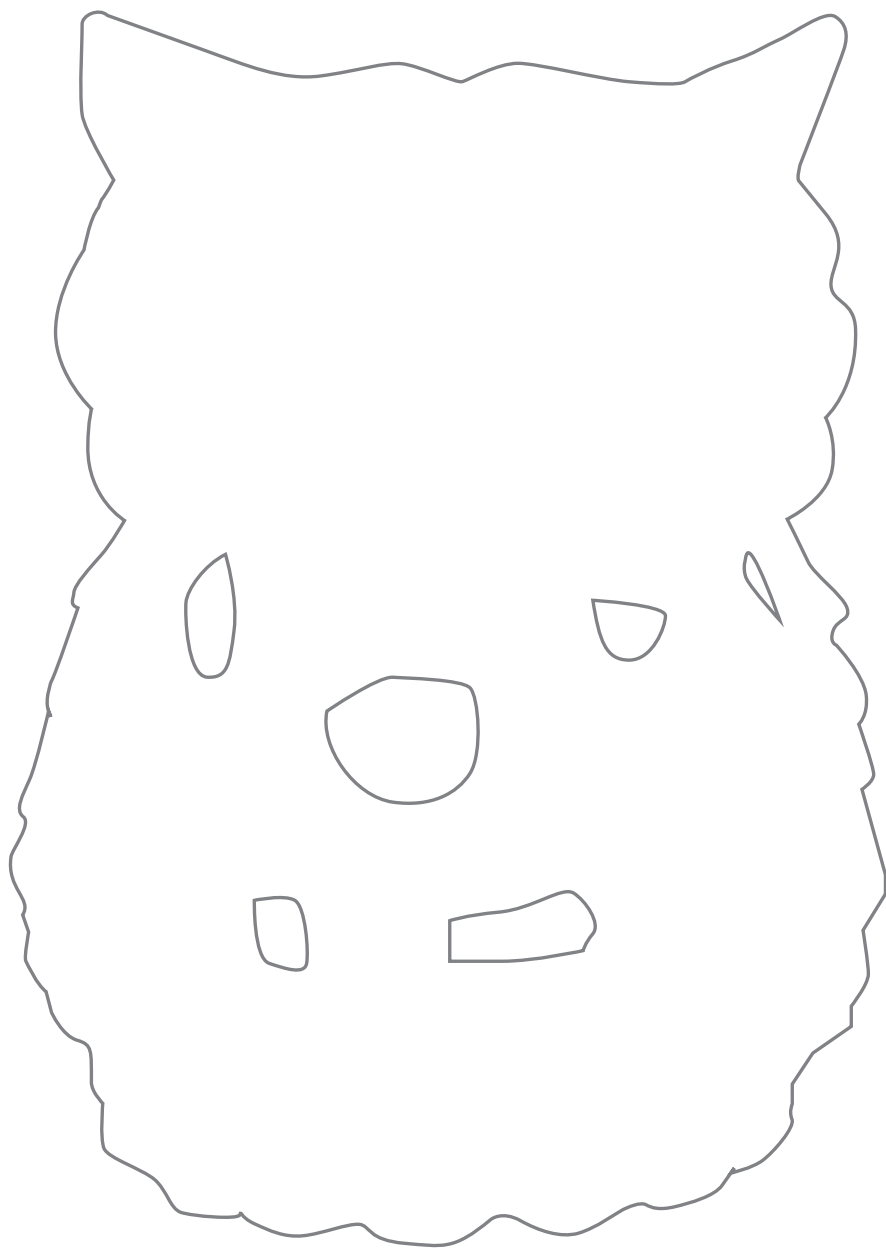




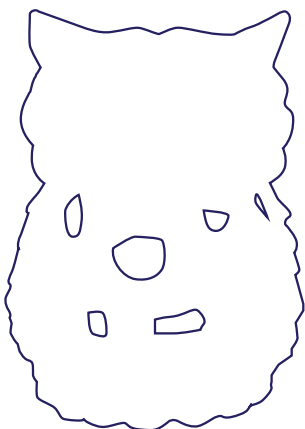
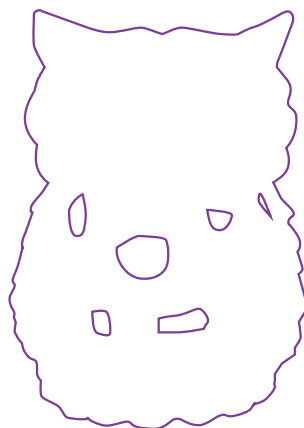
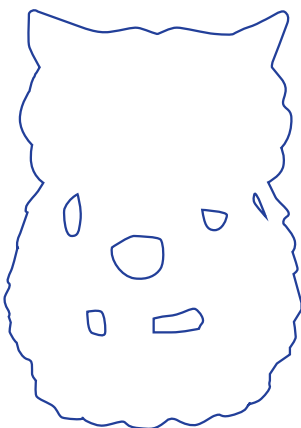
























An great horned owl holding a glow stick at a party.





The ceramic owl is based on the Great Horned Owl (*Bubo virginianus*). They are approximately 18 to 25 inches tall, weighing between 2 and 5.5 pounds, with females being larger than males, and have a wingspan of up to five feet. The Great Horned Owl is named for the feather tufts on top of its head, which mimic horns, but these tufts are primarily used for camouflage, blending in with its mottled brown, gray, and white feathers that blend with foliage. One distinctive feature of the Great Horned Owl is the white patch under its throat, commonly referred to as the bib. Even though the Great Horned Owl has a grip strength of up to 300 pounds per square inch, the ceramic owl doesn't have any feet to hunt small mammals.

The ceramic owl candle holder resembles a vintage-style figurine, hand-glazed with a glossy finish. The glaze carries warm, earthy tones with accents of cold on the feathers around the front. There are feather clusters that resemble corn kernels, providing texture, while others are relatively smaller to promote diversity in feather sizes. The eyes are surrounded by white disks like those of Great Horned Owls, with a black beak between the white disks. Similar to the Great Horned Owls, the eyes are fixed in place, albeit a little lopsided or lazy-eyed.

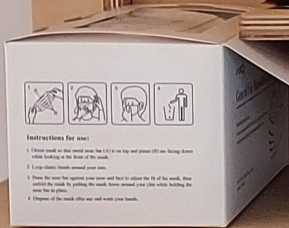
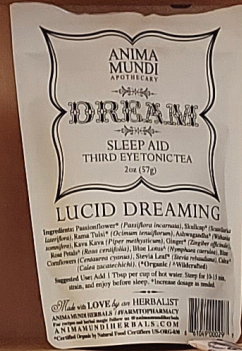
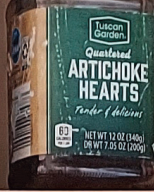
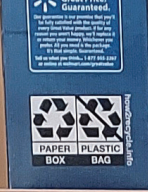






The owl I replicated is named Floppy. He is a little lopsided, but he is special. Floppy was made using cardboard boxes provided by my job, McDonald's. He was initially a prototype for Bubo, my two-foot-tall owl. However, I wanted Bubo to be built proportionally and correctly, so it is taking me longer than usual to make Bubo. Until Bubo comes into being, Floopy is the cousin nobody wants to talk about.







Lux, my ceramic candle owl, was given to me on my birthday by my best friend. We have been friends for almost a decade now, and she knows that I have a love for owls. When I was in middle school, I used to study birds because I wanted to become an ornithologist. My best friend at the time also gifted me several owls since then. I was gifted three owl candles, owl book holders, an owl stitch pattern, and a paint-by-number owl.

I still love owls today. They are amazing birds, and I love this latest gift. I have yet to try putting a tea light in it, but I am waiting for the perfect moment. I am waiting for a rainy or snowy day, with no school or work, with a nice cup of coffee, and then I will light Lux at my nightstand.



An great horned owl flying in the dark dragging the sun behind him.

Samantha McClain
11 12 2025
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